This is FORM G

Here's a comprehensive list of **gestures** early education teachers can use to teach **phoneme sounds**. These gestures pair physical movement with phonemic awareness, which is highly effective for young learners, especially when used alongside handwriting and spelling instruction.

I've organized this list by **phoneme categories** (consonants, vowels, digraphs) and included **suggested gestures** for each sound. These can be adapted or expanded depending on your curriculum (e.g., if you're using a program like **Jolly Phonics**, **Orton-Gillingham**, or **Fundations**, you may want to align gestures accordingly).

🔤 Consonant Phonemes & Gestures

Phoneme	Sound	Gesture Idea
/b/	as in *bat*	"Bounce a ball" with both hands
/k/	as in *cat*	Pretend to crack an egg open
/d/	as in *dog*	Tap fingers like playing a drum
/f/	as in *fish*	Wiggle fingers like fish swimming
/g/	as in *goat*	Pull down a pretend goat beard
/h/	as in *hat*	Fan your face (blowing hot air)
/j/	as in *jam*	Pretend to spread jam on bread
/l/	as in *lip*	Move hand in a flowing wave (like licking lips)
/m/	as in *man*	Rub belly like "mmm, yummy"
/n/	as in *net*	Wiggle fingers downward like net catching fish
/p/	as in *pig*	Clap hands softly like popping bubbles
/r/	as in *rat*	Wiggle fingers near mouth like whiskers
/s/	as in *sun*	Trace a spiral sun in the air
/t/	as in *tap*	Tap index finger on the palm of other hand
/v/	as in *van*	Drive an imaginary steering wheel
/w/	as in *wind*	Swoop hands like blowing wind
/y/	as in *yes*	Nod head and give thumbs up
/z/	as in *zoo*	Wiggle index fingers like a buzzing bee
/x/	as in *box*	Cross forearms in an “X” shape

✨ Short Vowel Phonemes & Gestures

Phoneme	Sound	Gesture Idea
/a/	as in *apple*	Pretend to take a bite of an apple
/e/	as in *elephant*	Make an elephant trunk with arm
/i/	as in *insect*	Wiggle fingers like crawling bugs
/o/	as in *octopus*	Wiggle fingers like octopus tentacles
/u/	as in *umbrella*	Pretend to open an umbrella overhead

🌀 Long Vowel Sounds & Gestures

Phoneme	Sound	Gesture Idea
/ā/	as in *cake*	Draw a straight line across air (like a cake slice)
/ē/	as in *feet*	Wiggle fingers down toward feet
/ī/	as in *kite*	Trace a kite shape in the air
/ō/	as in *rope*	Pretend to pull a rope
/ū/	as in *cube*	Pretend to blow out a birthday candle (small puff sound)

🤝 Digraphs & Blends (Consonant Teams)

Phoneme	Sound	Gesture Idea
/sh/	as in *ship*	Put finger to lips (shhh)
/ch/	as in *chop*	Pretend to chop with side of hand
/th/	as in *thumb*	Show thumbs up
/wh/	as in *whale*	Move hand in a swimming motion
/ng/	as in *sing*	Pretend to sing (open mouth, hand to ear)
/qu/	as in *queen*	Place pretend crown on head

🔁 R-Controlled Vowels

Phoneme	Sound	Gesture Idea
/ar/	as in *car*	Pretend to steer a car
/or/	as in *fork*	Pretend to eat with fork
/er/ /ir/ /ur/	as in *her*, *bird*, *fur*	Tap chest like you're thinking "hmm"

🗣️ Tips for Implementation

- Always **say the sound aloud** as you do the gesture.
- Use gestures during **spelling dictation**, **sound review**, and **handwriting warm-ups**.
- Keep gestures **consistent** across all phonics lessons.
- Encourage students to **mirror the gesture** when you say the sound.